

Michael Lugaresi

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Professional Summary

3D Character Artist with a BA (Hons) in Game Art & Animation from SAE Institute London, specialising in character design and complete AAA Game Development Pipelines. I bridge traditional craftsmanship (as a former Goldsmith and Sculptor) with digital innovation, ensuring exceptional anatomical accuracy and highly optimised game-ready assets. Expert in high-poly sculpting, low-poly retopology, PBR texturing, and rigging. I actively integrate Generative AI tools into my workflow to accelerate brainstorming, generate animation references, and iteratively refine design concepts. Multilingual professional (Italian native, English C1 Advanced, Spanish A2) accustomed to cross-functional collaboration and delivering high-end assets under strict production deadlines.

Technical Skills

- 3D & Game Engines: Autodesk Maya, ZBrush, Unreal Engine 5 (Real-Time Rendering, Look Development), Blender
 - Texturing & 2D: Adobe Substance 3D Painter (PBR Texturing), Fiber Shop, Adobe Photoshop, Krita, After Effects
 - Pipeline & Methodologies: Full-Stack 3D Pipeline, High-Poly Sculpting, Low-Poly Modelling, UV Mapping & Unwrapping, Texture Baking, Rigging, Skinning, Asset Optimisation
 - AI Integration: Generative AI for concept art brainstorming, design iteration, and animation references
 - Traditional Art: Clay Sculpting, Human & Creature Anatomy, Goldsmithing (Gold, Platinum, Silver), Micro-detailing, Chiselling
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Work Experience

SAE Institute London | 3D Character Artist (Selected Projects) | 2024 – Present

- Individual Project “Deja Vu” – Character Design (Avila Terence)

Developed the character to strict AAA industry standards. Executed the full character pipeline: High-Poly Sculpting in ZBrush, Low-Poly Retopology and UV Mapping in Maya, PBR Texturing in Substance Painter, Real-Time Rendering in Unreal Engine 5. Integrated AI workflows for visual design refinement.

- Team Project “Cyber City” – Lead Modeller

Developed foundational 3D assets ensuring technical consistency and optimisation.

Coordinated the art team and managed milestones with Gantt charts, delivering 100% on time.

Personal Projects

- Raven Protocol (Stellar Blade Tribute)
Created complete 2D concept sheet + exploded parts ready for 3D high-poly sculpting in ZBrush (mechanical tendrils, cyber armor, PBR details).
 - St. Eurosia (Fantasy Character inspired by Lord of the Fallen)
Full character design with 2D concept board, orthogonal projections and ready-to-sculpt assets.
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Previous Professional Experience

Goldsmith & Finishing Specialist – Dai Tien Diamond, London (2019)
Delivered high-precision polishing and micro-detailing for luxury jewellery, increasing production efficiency by 10% while maintaining elite quality under tight deadlines.

Graphic Designer – 4th Alpini Paratroopers Regiment “Ranger”, Italy (2011)
Designed official unit insignia (Ranger/Predator motif) managing full design lifecycle from research to production-ready assets.

Assistant Sculptor – Rossi Franca Studio, Cesena, Italy (2007–2009)
Optimised Raku clay preparation (boosting studio productivity by 50%), managed inventory and meticulous detailing.

Education

BA (Hons) Game Art & Animation – SAE Institute London (2024 – 2026)
Guitar & Composition Studies – RGA Milan (2 years) – applied to animation timing and rhythm
A-Level Art & BTEC Art Jewelry & Design – Istituto d’Arte di Forlì (2005–2008)
BTEC Graphic Design – Istituto d’Arte Paolo Toschi, Parma (2001–2004)

Languages

Italian (Native) | English (C1 Advanced) | Spanish (A2)